CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

CAR FLIPPING IN THE AI ERA

Buy the car nobody wants to deal with, fix the reason, sell it to somebody who just wants a car.

★ **TL;DR — Around $75K a year for a full-time flipper with a good eye, startable in 1–6 months. The catch: state dealer laws cap how many cars a private seller can move — the legal line is part of the business plan.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

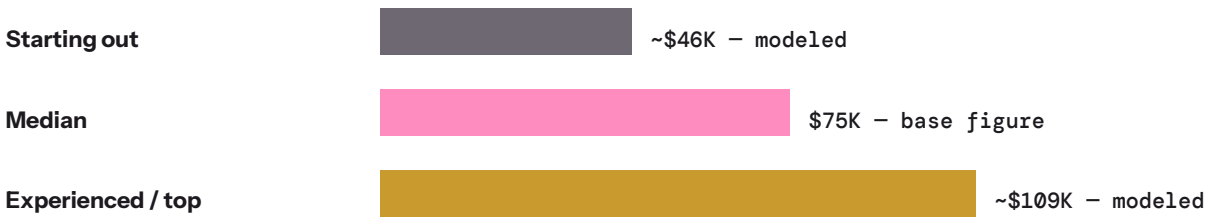
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- The money is in the buy and the reconditioning: cheap because of a fixable problem, sold because the problem is gone.
- Detailing and honest presentation add real resale value for weekend-level effort.
- Titles, taxes and dealer-licensing rules are not fine print — they decide whether this is a business or a violation.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Car Flipping is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A CAR FLIPPING ACTUALLY DO?

✓ Hunt underpriced cars: private sellers, auctions, trade-ins nobody wants
✓ Inspect mechanically and legally — title status first, engine second
✓ Repair, detail and photograph the car properly
✓ List, meet buyers, negotiate, and handle the paperwork cleanly

Think: a matchmaker for used cars — you find the diamond with a dead battery and introduce it to its next owner.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI scans listings for underpricing, decodes auction data and drafts ads. Mispriced cars get spotted faster — the easy pickings now require speed.	The test drive stays human: the transmission hesitation at 40, the title story that does not add up, the seller who will take less if you are standing there with cash and courtesy.

⚠ **Curbstoning — flipping cars without a dealer license where one is required — can bring fines and banned accounts. And one hidden frame-damage or title-washed car can eat a season of small wins.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Fast cycles: a good flip turns in days or weeks, not seasons ✓ Every deal is a puzzle with a cash answer ✓ Scales from driveway to dealer lot if you formalize	✗ Buyers flake, haggle and message at midnight ✗ Your cash is always inside a car somebody has not bought yet ✗ Weekend showings are the sales floor

Good fit? A car-savvy negotiator who can judge mechanical condition, price honestly and follow the legal path from the start.
Bad fit? You plan to skip titles, taxes and licensing rules to 'stay under the radar', or you cannot tell a head gasket from a cup holder.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — A FEW CLEAN FLIPS, BY THE BOOK	DOOR B — GET THE DEALER LICENSE

Start as a private seller within your state's yearly limit: buy in your name, title in your name, sell honestly. Small volume, full legality, and you learn the market with real deals.	If the math works and volume calls, formalize: dealer license, lot or office as your state requires, dealer insurance and auction access. More cost and rules — and a real business that can scale.

Smart move: Specialize in one model range until you can price any example from a photo and a mileage number. Flippers earn on certainty — the narrower your expertise, the fewer surprises per deal.

Where you land after: A licensed small dealership or a wholesale operation feeding other dealers — the flips become inventory strategy.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN YOUR	PICK YOUR	BUILD THE	BUY THE	RECONDITION AND	SELL, LOG,

STEP 1 — Learn your state's rules first

FREE · 1 WEEK

- Find the exact limit on private-party sales per year and what triggers dealer licensing in your state.
- Learn title types cold: clean, rebuilt, salvage — and what each does to value and legality.

STEP 2 — Pick your model lane

FREE · 2 WEEKS

- Choose a few models with deep buyer demand and parts you can source cheaply.
- Study sold prices until you can smell an underpriced listing in one read.

STEP 3 — Build the money and tools

$500-3,000 · 2 WEEKS

- Scanner, jack, detailing kit and a relationship with a mechanic for pre-purchase checks.
- Register properly for taxes from the first sale — flipping income is business income.

STEP 4 — Buy the first car slowly

CAPITAL · WEEKS 3-6

- Clean title, fixable issues, bought under your written maximum — no exceptions for 'rare finds'.
- Verify the title and VIN history before money moves, every single time.

STEP 5 — Recondition and present

$200-1,000 · 1-2 WEEKS

- Fix what you promised yourself you would fix; detail until the car photographs like the asking price.
- Write honest listings: flaws stated plainly build the reviews that sell car number ten.

STEP 6 — Sell, log, repeat — legally

PAID · ONGOING

- Log every deal fully: buy, parts, hours, sale. Your real hourly rate decides if this scales.
- Watch your yearly count against the state limit — when you approach it, the dealer license conversation starts.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: read your state's private-sale limits and dealer rules, and pick your model lane.
- □ Days 1–30: study prices, line up inspection help, and scan listings daily without buying.
- □ Days 31–60: buy and recondition the first car by the book; sell it with a clean, honest listing.
- □ Days 61–90: repeat with tighter numbers, and decide if volume justifies the dealer path.
- □ Day 90: a few honest flips logged and a clear answer: hobby money, side business, or dealership embryo.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ CLEAN TITLE, CLEAN PROFIT. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.